Capstone Process
Kick-off Session

Thursday March 12th, 2026

BUS 497: Capstone and Internship

What is it?

The Capstone = Internship + Weekly Online Class

Gain **real experience** through your internship
and **reflect, connect, and grow** in the weekly seminar.

Two parts. One course. Real-world learning.

Avoid the Cliff: Secure Your Internship *Before* Class!

Why This Matters

Especially important for Summer/Fall 2026 graduates

- **To graduate with the Business Certificate:** You must complete the Capstone
- **To enroll in Capstone (BUS 497):** You need an approved internship BEFORE the course starts
- **Timeline is tight:** We're in March 2026. If you're graduating in 2026, you need to act NOW
- **For everyone else:** Start planning early to avoid last-minute stress

What Actually Counts?

Hours:	15+ hours/week
Duration:	10+ weeks (Fall/Spring) / 8+ weeks (Summer)
Job/Role/Function:	Operations, Sales, HR, Marketing, etc (BUS-261)
Supervisor:	Must have an employer point person
Work Project:	Identifiable project you'll complete
Compensation:	Paid preferred; unpaid accepted

Ideally links to your career goals.

Job Searching

Finding internships is challenging right now

- The job market is competitive - you're not imagining it
- Apply regularly and broadly - consistency beats cramming
- This requires strategy, creativity, and persistence
- Starting early gives you more options and less stress

This session will help you think strategically about where to look and how to approach the search

Job Search Strategy

Start with who you already know – Network:

Ask: "Is there anyone else I can speak to?" Create a chain

Offer a solution: “What do you need help with?”

Apply broadly and often

Don't just send 5 applications and give up. Aim for 10+ per week.

Tailor your applications

Customize your resume and cover letter for each opportunity

Be open!

Your dream role might come from an unexpected place

Have a Plan A AND Plan B

Especially if you're close to graduation

Strategy: Offer a Solution

- A family member's business that needs a social media campaign or marketing strategy
- A small business owner who **needs help** streamlining operations or processes
- A nonprofit in your community that needs fundraising support or program development
- A local restaurant that wants to improve their online presence
- Someone self-employed who needs basic business infrastructure (invoicing, client tracking, etc.)

Stay Organized: Job Tracker

We're providing you with a **Job Tracker spreadsheet** to help you manage your search

What to track:

- **Job Applications** Every position you apply to, status updates, interview dates
- **Contacts** Professional connections, networking contacts, follow-up reminders
- **Follow-ups** Scheduled outreach to recruiters and hiring managers
- **Resources** Useful links, job boards, career prep materials

The Approval Process

1. Meet and Talk to us!
2. Find and secure your internship opportunity
3. Submit the Capstone Approval Request Form
4. Get approval confirmation (usually within 48 hours)
5. Register for BUS 497 Capstone

We cannot guarantee a spot in the class if you wait until the last minute!

Key Deadlines & Timeline

Summer or Fall 2026 Capstone Classes:

Internship should be approved 2 weeks BEFORE class begins

Start searching NOW if you haven't already started!

Approval typically takes: 48 hours after you submit all required info

Resources & Support

Business Certificate Team

Emails: **buscert@hunter.cuny.edu** or Pete Readman: **pr176@hunter.cuny.edu**

Book an appointment: **Pete Readman (Navigate)**

Drop-in hours: **Mondays 1-3pm, HW 1531**

Hunter Career Services

Individual coaching sessions, workshops, drop-in support

Events Calendar

Capstone Approval Form

Submit this form once you have secured an opportunity

Questions & Final Reminders

Time for Q&A!

Remember:

- Don't wait until the last minute
- Internship must be approved BEFORE enrolling in Capstone
- Tell us as soon as you have something lined up
- We're here to help—reach out anytime

General: buscert@hunter.cuny.edu

Pete: pr1760@hunter.cuny.edu